Workshop Title: Venture Financing as a Mechanism for Sustainable Post-War Economic Rebuilding: The Case of Ukraine

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1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this 90-minute workshop, Master's students in Economics and Finance will be able to:

- **Identify and differentiate** the three key stages of Ukraine's post-war rebuilding strategy (stability, restoration, and modernization) as defined at the Lugano Ukraine Recovery Conference, including their respective financial requirements and timeframes
- **Analyse and classify** the specific roles of different venture financing actors (business angels, venture funds, international organizations, and corporate venture capital divisions) within each stage of the post-war rebuilding process
- **Evaluate** the capacity and limitations of venture financing as an alternative and complementary source of financial support for sustainable post-war reconstruction, relative to traditional financing instruments
- **Apply** the principles of sustainable development (economic, social, and environmental sustainability) to assess the alignment between venture financing instruments and post-war rebuilding priorities in Ukraine
- **Critically assess** the financial architecture of the Ukraine Recovery Plan, including the estimated resource requirements of approximately $750 billion across 850 projects, and the structural distribution of financing sources

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2. Session Outline

Time	Activity	Description
0–10 min	**Welcome & Diagnostic Poll**	Facilitator introduces the workshop context: the full-scale Russian invasion of Ukraine, the Lugano Ukraine Recovery Conference (2022), and the estimated reconstruction cost of $349 billion EUR (World Bank/European Commission, September 2022). Students respond to a brief 3-question diagnostic poll to gauge prior knowledge of venture financing and post-war reconstruction concepts. Facilitator outlines the session structure and learning objectives.
10–30 min	**Lecture Input: Sustainability Framework & Rebuilding Stages**	Structured mini-lecture covering: (1) The three key principles of sustainable post-war rebuilding — stability, restoration, and modernization — as presented in Figure 1 of the PDF; (2) The evolution of Ukraine Reform Conferences (London 2017 through Lugano 2022) as presented in Figure 2; (3) The financial scale of each stage: stability (~$60–65 billion, 1 year), restoration (>$300 billion, ~2 years), and modernization (>$400 billion, ~5 years); (4) The structure of financing sources (grants, credit funds, and private investments) as outlined in Figure 3. Students take structured notes using a provided framework template.
30–55 min	**Small Group Analysis Exercise**	Students are divided into three groups, each assigned one rebuilding stage (stability, restoration, or modernization). Using the PDF

content, each group maps: (a) the functional directions relevant to their stage (e.g., housing, energy, IT, logistics, healthcare, agriculture, education); (b) the most appropriate venture financing actors for their stage (e.g., business angels for stability; venture funds and international organizations for restoration; corporate venture capital divisions and investment banks for modernization); (c) the key characteristics required of financing instruments at their stage (e.g., flexibility and urgency for stability; long-term capacity for restoration). Groups prepare a brief structured summary for plenary presentation. |
| 55–75 min | **Plenary Presentations & Critical Discussion** | Each group presents their findings (approximately 4–5 minutes per group). Facilitator moderates a structured discussion using key discussion points (see Section 3). Specific attention is drawn to: the role of business angels at the stability stage providing both capital and consulting/mentoring; the dual micro/macro role of venture funds and international organizations at the restoration stage (as illustrated in Figure 5); and the Google Ventures (GV) model cited in the PDF as an example of corporate venture capital applicable to the modernization stage. Facilitator synthesises cross-group findings on the whiteboard. |
| 75–90 min | **Synthesis, Reflection & Wrap-Up** | Facilitator delivers a 5-minute synthesis connecting all three stages into the overarching sustainable post-war rebuilding model (Figure 4). Students individually complete a structured exit reflection card (3 prompts: one key insight, one remaining question, one practical implication). Facilitator highlights key takeaways (see Section 6), references the upcoming UK Ukraine Recovery Conference (2023) mentioned in the PDF, and assigns the post-workshop task. |

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3. Key Discussion Points

The following core concepts, drawn directly from the PDF, are designated for structured group and plenary discussion:

1. **The adequacy of existing financing sources:** The PDF notes that Ukraine's State Statistics Service identified enterprise own funds and state budget funds as the primary sources of innovative activity financing, while acknowledging that data on grant financing, crowdfunding, and venture fund resources remain limited. Students should discuss: *What are the implications of this data gap for designing a comprehensive post-war financing strategy?*

2. **The Marshall Plan analogy and its applicability:** The PDF references the post-WWII Marshall Plan ($13 billion in aid, covering 17 European countries, resulting in 35% industrial growth from 1948–1952) as a historical precedent. Students should discuss: *To what extent is the Marshall Plan model transferable to Ukraine's post-war context, and where does it fall short?*

3. **Business angels at the stability stage:** The PDF argues that business angels are particularly suited to the stability stage due to their flexibility, capacity for urgent capital deployment, and ability to combine financial support with consulting and mentoring services. Students should discuss: *What structural conditions would need to be in place in post-war Ukraine to attract business angel investment at scale?*

4. **The dual role of venture funds and international organizations at the restoration stage:** The PDF distinguishes between venture funds operating at the micro level (supporting individual innovative projects) and international organizations operating at the macro level (supporting venture financing policy and programme-for-results financing). Students should discuss: *How should the responsibilities of these two actor types be coordinated to avoid duplication or gaps in coverage?*

5. **Corporate venture capital as a modernization instrument:** The PDF cites Google Ventures (GV), founded in 2009 and partnering with Alphabet, as an example of a corporate venture capital model that could be applied to Ukraine's modernization stage. Students should discuss: *What sectors of the Ukrainian economy (e.g., IT, energy, logistics, medicine) are most suited to attracting this type of investor, and why?*

6. **ESG considerations and the war context:** The PDF notes that the war has created new tensions for ESG investors and negatively influenced socially responsible initiatives and "green" project realization. Students should discuss: *How can venture financing instruments be structured to maintain ESG alignment during and after a conflict period?*

7. **The role of the Advantage Ukraine platform and startup ecosystem:** The PDF references the electronic platform Advantage Ukraine (500+ investment projects across 10 sectors) and ten Ukrainian startups presented at TechCrunch Disrupt. Students should discuss: *What does the continued activity of Ukrainian startups during wartime suggest about the resilience and potential of the national venture ecosystem?*

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4. Activities & Exercises

Exercise 1: Three-Stage Venture Financing Mapping (Group Activity — conducted during 30–55 min segment)

Students are divided into three groups corresponding to the three rebuilding stages. Each group receives a structured worksheet with the following prompts, all to be answered using PDF content exclusively:

- *What is the estimated financial requirement and timeframe for your assigned stage?*
- *Which functional directions (e.g., housing, energy, IT, logistics, healthcare, agriculture, education, security) are associated with your stage, as identified in Figure 4 of the PDF?*
- *Which venture financing actors are identified in the PDF as most appropriate for your stage, and what specific characteristics make them suitable?*
- *What is one real-world example from the PDF that illustrates venture activity relevant to your stage?*

Groups document their findings on a shared template and present to the plenary. This exercise directly operationalises the analytical framework presented in Figures 4 and 5 of the PDF.

Exercise 2: Financing Source Classification Task (Individual Activity — conducted during 55–75 min segment)

Each student receives a list of ten financing instruments and actors drawn from the PDF (e.g., EU macro-financial assistance, business angels, EBRD, World Bank tenders, Ukrainian Startup Fund, corporate venture capital divisions, investment banks, proceeds from Russian asset sales, international technical assistance programmes, and participatory budgeting of local projects). Students must:

- Assign each instrument/actor to one or more of the three rebuilding stages (stability, restoration, modernization)
- Provide a one-sentence justification for each assignment, citing the relevant section of the PDF